Mission Chronos

Team activity | November 13 | Duration: 1 h 45

The Scenario

It is the year 2032. The company loses thousands of hours every year in a time rift called The Timesheet Void.

Employees work, attend Teams meetings, create PRs and move projects forward. Yet part of their time disappears because it is never entered in 7pace.

Your team has been recruited to build Chronos, an intelligent assistant that can reconstruct a workday and propose a near-automatic timesheet.

Your weapon: a Dark Factory you will program to build Chronos on its own. You have 1 h 45 before the time rift becomes permanent.

What Is a Dark Factory?

In manufacturing, a dark factory is a fully automated plant that runs with nobody on the floor. You can turn off the lights: the machines produce on their own.

In software development, the idea is the same. AI agents turn tickets into a working application, from code to tests, without a human touching the keyboard. Human work moves upstream: defining the need clearly and building the harness that guides and controls the agents.

That is exactly what you will build today.

The Mission

Have Claude build an application that simplifies time entry in 7pace: reconstruct an employee's week, validate it, get it approved and prepare it for 7pace.

No connection to 7pace or any other system. Everything lives in the application, with its own backend and its own local data (for example SQLite).

Input data is simulated: the data/week1.json and data/week2.json files, provided in the repo, hold two fictitious weeks of a fictitious employee with Teams meetings, commits, PRs, work items and absences. The application reads them and never modifies them.

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Minimum Expectations

At a minimum, your solution should:

- have a user interface (UI) and its own backend
- distinguish Project, Management and Administration time
- validate each week against Progi's time entry rules (below)
- offer an approval workflow: the employee submits the week, a manager approves or rejects it with a comment, and an approved week is locked. You switch roles in the UI, with no authentication
- display a few useful KPIs
- meet Progi's basic quality and security standards

Progi's Time Entry Rules

The application rejects a week that breaks these rules, with a clear message:

- 40 hours per week, except for sickness, vacation or absence
- the daily 20-minute break is not entered
- training time goes under code 5843
- no entry overlaps another
- every entry has a category

At Progi, 7pace already distinguishes several categories: general administration, team management, product management, client management and project time.

Going Further

To prioritize with your PO or analyst, depending on time:

- **Smart suggestions:** from the simulated data, the application proposes entries (a meeting becomes Management, a PR becomes Project) and remembers the user's corrections. A correction made on week 1 applies to the suggestions for week 2.
- **7pace export:** the application produces a CSV file ready to import into 7pace, only for an approved week.

You decide the workflow, the features, the UX and what you automate.

The rest is up to you to imagine.

How It Works

You don't write the application. You write what guides and controls the agent that writes it. Claude creates, builds and runs the whole app.

Each team receives its repo, in PHP or C#, containing:

- a skeleton harness to complete (agents, hooks, gates, CLAUDE.md)
- two simulated data files, data/week1.json and data/week2.json
- a TICKET.md for the analysts' tickets, which you can replace or complement with one file per ticket (see below)
- a few limits already in place: at most 3 automatic retries, at most 3 "build, evaluate, fix" cycles, and a cheaper model for the evaluator and reviewer

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Where to Put the Tickets

The tickets written by the analysts can be organized in two ways:

- **One file:** all the tickets in the TICKET.md.
- **Several files:** a separate file for each ticket (for example tickets/ticket-01.md, tickets/ticket-02.md), in a dedicated folder read by the factory.

Developers decide with the analyst or PO on the best approach, then adapt the factory accordingly.

Roles

The Clients

The clients are Olivier Voyer and Morgane Couture. They know the need and will answer your questions.

Harness Master

- One per team (except for the BI and Infra/DevOps teams). Receives the harness starter files the day before the workshop and may not share them with anyone.
- Prepares the team's repo and shows everyone how to launch Claude Code with a clean configuration.
- At the start of the harness phase, checks with the team that only the workshop harness is loaded.
- Guides the developers in building the harness and makes sure the factory is ready before the bell.

Your goal: a factory ready to go the moment the bell rings.

Analysts, POs and Agile Managers

- Understand the need by asking the clients questions.
- Write the tickets with Claude AI during the harness phase, either all in the TICKET.md or in a separate file for each ticket. Each ticket holds a user story and testable acceptance criteria. Also state how to run the app.
- Work with the developers so the harness can check every criterion.

Your goal: complete, clear tickets before the bell. After that, it's too late to change them.

Developers

- Build the harness: write agents, hooks, gates and the CLAUDE.md. Test, fail, try again.
- Choose how your team works: mob programming, all together on one workstation, or splitting the work (agents, hooks, gates, CLAUDE.md) and then merging it. To be discussed as a team.
- Decide with the analyst or PO how to organize the tickets: one file or one file per ticket.
- Set up permissions so no manual approval is needed after the bell.
- Follow the rule: only the main session writes code. The planner, evaluator and reviewer stay read-only.

Your goal: a factory that can deliver the tickets end to end, on its own.

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The Bell Rings: Hands in Pockets

When the bell rings, open a new Claude Code session. One person types one launch message:

```
Build TICKET.md end to end following CLAUDE.md.
```

- This message is the same for every team. If your tickets are spread across several files, your factory must know how to find them from this message.
- After that, hands in pockets for 15 minutes.
- Touching the keyboard after launch costs a penalty, including approving a permission.
- When the 15 minutes are up, sessions are stopped whether the factory finished or not. A factory that didn't finish is a result to present, not a failure.

What to Know Before the Event

- In-person attendance is mandatory for employees who live in Quebec, unless there is a major conflict.
- Remote participants join the Teams meeting, with one breakout room per team.
- Bring your laptop, with Claude Code installed and up to date.
- One Harness Master per team (except for the BI and Infra/DevOps teams) will receive the harness starter files the day before the workshop, only to make setting up the activity easier. They may not share them with anyone.
- Clone the workshop repo in a separate folder, outside your usual workspace (for example C:\workshop), so Claude doesn't load the CLAUDE.md files of your other repos.
- Claude Code will be launched with a clean configuration, without your personal plugins, agents, hooks or CLAUDE.md. Your Harness Master will show you how. You start from the skeleton harness provided.
- At the start of the harness phase, check with /memory, /hooks, /agents and /plugin that only the workshop harness is loaded.
- No Progi code and no client data in the repos.

Schedule

Time	Step	Details
0:00	Harness phase (1 h)	Mission briefing and repo handoff. **POs/Analysts:** client questions and writing the tickets with Claude AI (one file or one file per ticket). **Developers:** building and testing the harness, setting up permissions.
1:00	The bell rings (15 min)	New Claude Code session, one launch message, hands in pockets.
1:15	Demos (30 min)	Demo of the application (or the crash) and handoff of your Claude skills and harness.

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Rules of the Game

1. You have 1 h 45, with the first hour dedicated to the harness.
2. Nobody writes application code by hand, not even during the harness phase.
3. Once the factory is launched after the harness phase, there is no code review and no human approval gate. Only your harness's automated checks decide.
4. Claude AI is mandatory for analysts.
5. Developers must use the harness.
6. Analysts and developers must truly collaborate.
7. This is a friendly competition: you can help each other, even if you are on different teams.
8. You may ask the clients as many questions as you want.
9. The clients will not volunteer all the answers.
10. You are free to prioritize the features.
11. A small product that works beats a big product that doesn't.
12. Teams must be ready for any surprise and adapt quickly. 👀
13. Be creative and original, try to stand out and create a WOW effect.

Scoring

Judges: Morgane Couture and Olivier Voyer.

Criteria	Points
Understanding of the need	15
User experience	15
Finished product	20
Use of AI skills	20
Harness creation	20
Originality and WOW factor	10
Total	100

Prizes

Prize	Awarded for
🏆 Master of Time	Best overall solution
🎨 UX Wizard	Best user experience
🤖 AI Power User	Best use of AI
🚀 Out of the Box	Most original idea

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Teams and Tables

Sync Team: table 1

Team 1	Team 2
Pierre-Marc Baril	Benoit Michaud (Harness Master)
Finaritra Razafimahazo (Harness Master)	Catherine Roy
Julio Romero	Igor Makalovich
Marc-André Janvier	Van du Tran

Pac Team: table 2

Pac Team
Charles Dufresne (Harness Master)
Pascal Godin
Stéphane Brault
Samuel Laporte
Nabila Oulhaci

BI Team: table 2

BI Team
Maxime Lehuidoux
Thomas Alonso
Athulya Asha
Olha Serada
Heriberto Sanchez (Remote)
Patrick Maldonado (Remote)
Dayana Merchan (Remote)

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Parts Team: table 3

Team 1	Team 2
Nathan Sicard	Katia Aubry
Jean-François Potvin	Maxime Lefebvre
Claude Limoges	Alexandre Sauvé
Fabien Bourdon (Harness Master)	Vincent Hould (Harness Master)
Antoine Guérin	François Gélinas

Pix Team: table 4

Pix Team
Dominic Villemure (Harness Master)
François Paproski
Maxime Pilon
Joannie Pellerin
Vanessa Vertzayias
Antoine Toutant (Harness Master)
Alexis Young
Cindy Agudelo

Infra/DevOps Team: table 5

Team 1	Team 2
Lucas Maurice	Alain Gires Ebouel
Marc-André Héroux	Dave Lemieux
Kevin Therrien	Vincent Rodier
Éric Boulanger	Christian Lambert
	Mathieu Godon

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Remote Team

Team 1	Team 2
Esteban Florido (Remote)	Jean-François Ratelle
Richard Morales (Harness Master, remote)	Laurent Tri
Maurice Collenne (Remote)	Billy Braga (Harness Master, remote)
Alex Rodrigues (Remote)	François Mongeau (Remote)
Juan David Sansmartin (Remote)	Dany Johan Pérez (Remote)
Oscar Ortiz (Remote)	Mohamed Ramoul (Remote)
Diego Guerrero (Remote)	Andrés Felipe Parra Rojas (Remote)

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